Aga Khan University Examination Board

Notes from E-Marking Centre on SSC-I Pakistan Studies Examination May 2018

Introduction:

This document has been produced for the teachers and candidates of the Secondary School Certificate (SSC) Part I (Class IX) subject in Pakistan Studies. It contains comments on candidates' responses to the 2018 SSC-I Examination, indicating the quality of the responses and highlighting their relative strengths and weaknesses.

E-Marking Notes:

This includes overall comments on students' performance on every question and *some* specific examples of students' responses which support the mentioned comments. Please note that the descriptive comments represent an overall perception of the better and weaker responses as gathered from the e-marking session. However, the candidates' responses shared in this document represent some specific example(s) of the mentioned comments.

Teachers and candidates should be aware that examiners may ask questions that address the Student Learning Outcomes (SLOs) in a manner that require candidates to respond by integrating knowledge, understanding and application skills they have developed during the course of study. Candidates are advised to read and comprehend each question carefully before writing the response to fulfil the demand of the question.

Candidates need to be aware that the marks allocated to the questions are related to the answer space provided on the examination paper as a guide to the length of the required response. A longer response will not in itself lead to higher marks. Candidates need to be familiar with the command words in the SLOs which contain terms commonly used in examination questions. However, candidates should also be aware that not all questions will start with or contain one of the command words. Words such as 'how', 'why' or 'what' may also be used.

General Comments:

It was generally felt that students lack basic historical knowledge necessary to answer various questions. Most candidates performed poorly in questions dealing with historical events and geography part. However, some candidates produced good responses to questions from these sections. In addition, it seemed that the candidates were not well prepared to answer opinion based questions and hence, were unable to perform well. It was also observed that students did not spend time in reading questions which led to poor answers, as in most cases, candidates wrote a general response without realising the demand of the question.

Note: Candidates' responses reproduced in this report have not been corrected for grammar, spelling, format or factual information.

Detailed Comments:

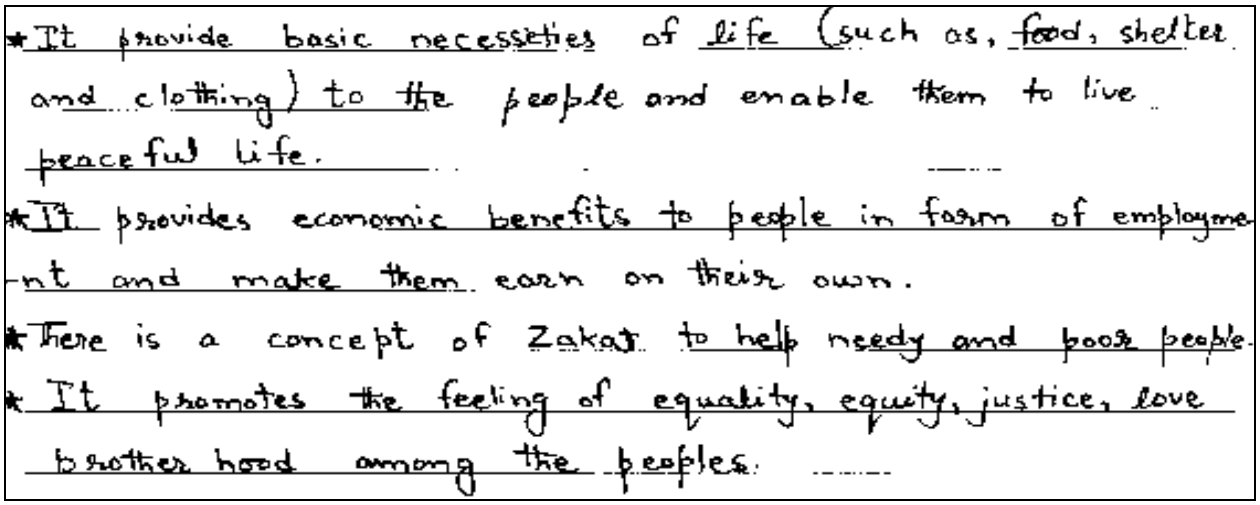
Constructed Response Questions (CRQs)

Question 1:

Describe any FOUR features of Islamic state which make it an ideal welfare state.

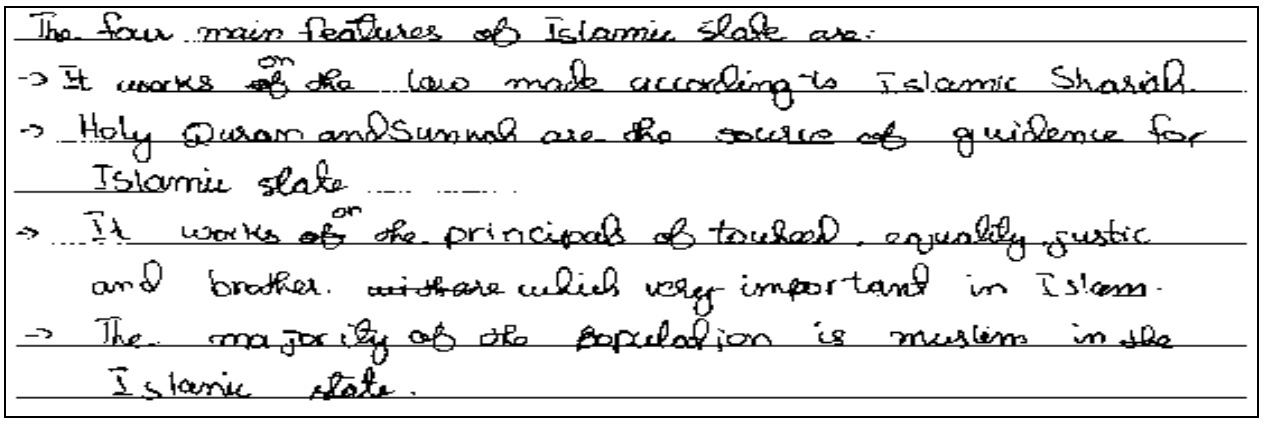
Better responses were those in which the candidates have mentioned all the important features of an Islamic state in connection with that of welfare state such as it provides basic facilities of life, like; food, shelter and clothing. An Islamic state makes sure that all of its citizens are equal and it promotes unity and brotherhood amongst the people. It also provides employment opportunities to the people of the state so that they can lead a peaceful and successful life.

Example:


*It provide basic necessities of life (such as, food, shelter and clothing) to the people and enable them to live peaceful life.
*It provides economic benefits to people in form of employment and make them earn on their own.
*There is a concept of Zakat to help needy and poor people.
*It promotes the feeling of equality, equity, justice, love brotherhood among the peoples.

Weaker responses talked about the characteristics or features of an Islamic state that it follows laws according to the shariah, the head of the state should be a Muslim. It is a state where holy Quran and sunnah leads them towards the right path etc. These statements were actually not required by the question. Some candidates compared Islamic state with the welfare state which was not asked in the question.

Example:


The four main features of Islamic State are:
-> It works on the laws made according to Islamic Shariah.
-> Holy Quran and Sunnah are the source of guidence for Islamic state.
-> It works on the principals of tauhed, equality, justic and brother. which very important in Islam.
-> The majority of the population is muslims in the Islamic state.

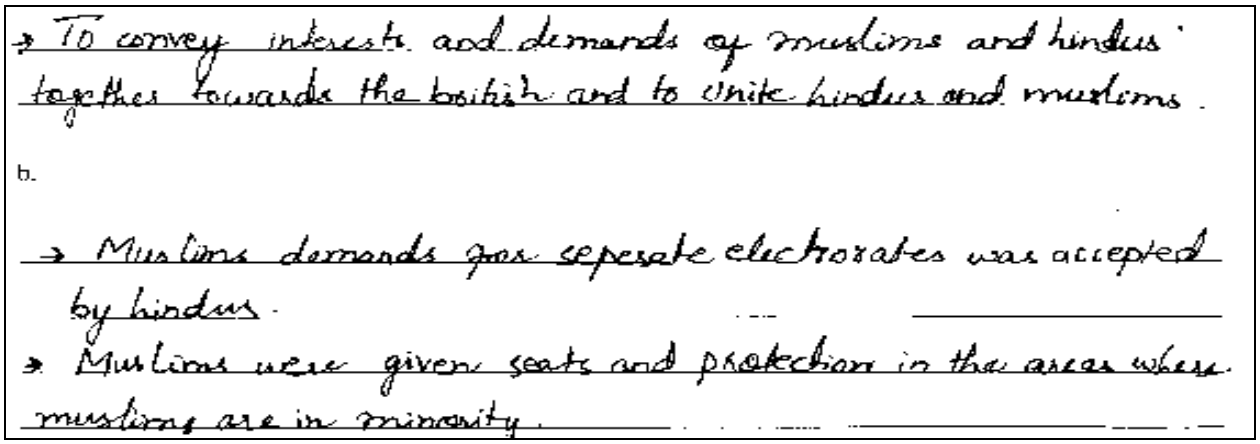
Question 2:

a. What was the main reason for the signing of the Lucknow Pact 1916?

b. Mention any TWO important clauses of the Pact that were advantageous for the of the subcontinent.

Better responses highlighted the relevant facts by giving a reason that Hindus and Muslims were united and together they wanted to convey their demands to the British. The two important clauses of the pact which most of the students stressed upon were that Hindus accepted the demand of separate electorates for the Muslims. On the other hand, Muslims were given seats and protection in the area where they were in minority.

Example:

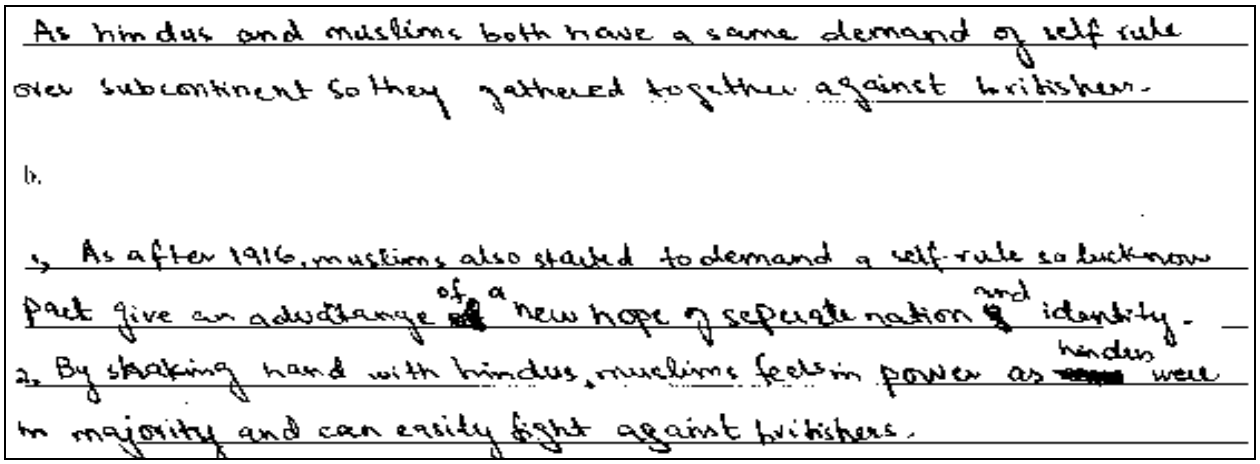

-> To convey interests and demands of muslims and hindus together towards the british and to unite hindus and muslims.

b.

-> Muslims demands for seperate electorates was accepted by hindus.
-> Muslims were given seats and protection in the areas where muslims are in minority.

Weaker responses merely focused on the concept of self-rule. They mostly discussed about the separate identification of Muslims and for that they were demanding a separate nation. It reflected the misconception of the candidates in regard to self-preservation and self-rule. Students have also highlighted that Hindus were in majority so they will fight against British and will rule over Muslims with power. Some of the students' responses reflected that they were not able to distinguish between different agreements and pacts, thus; they wrote generalised answers rather than being specific.

Example:


As hindus and muslims both have a same demand of self rule over subcontinent so they gathered together against britishers.

b.

1, As after 1916, muslims also started to demand a self rule so lucknow pact give an advantage of a new hope of seperate nation and identity.

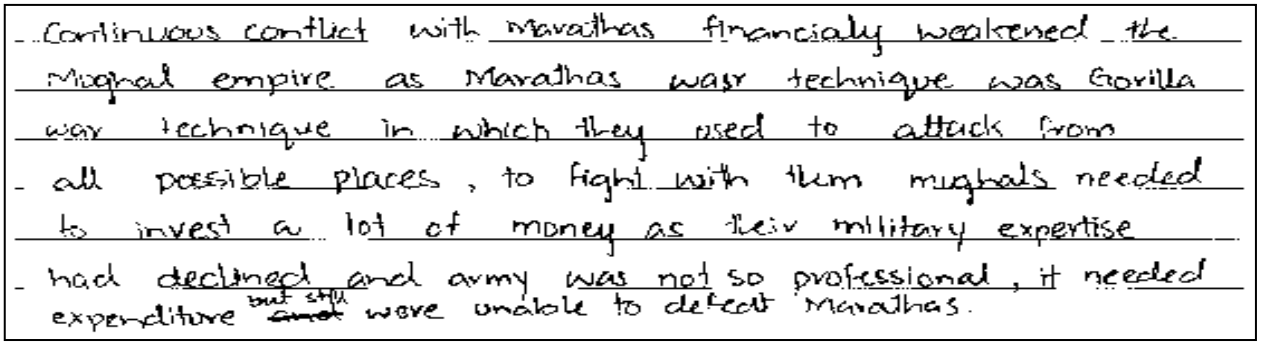
2, By shaking hand with hindus, muslims feels in power as hindus were in majority and can easily fight against britishers.

Question 3:

How did the continuous conflict with the Marathas contribute to the downfall of the Mughal Empire?

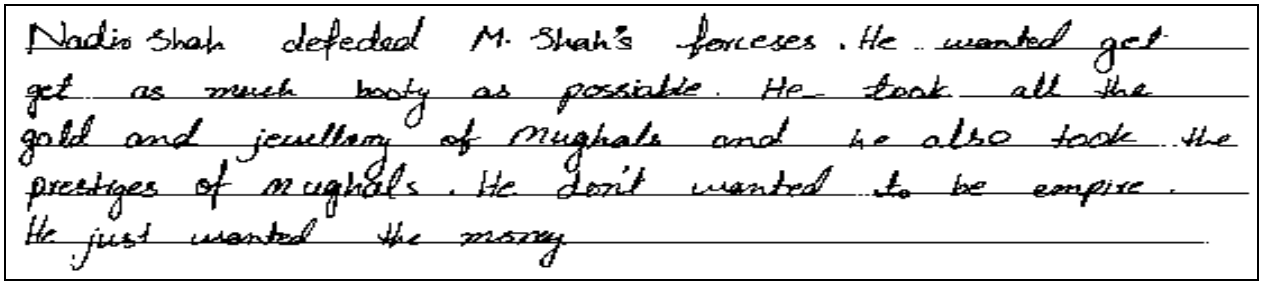
Better responses were those which had mentioned the reasons of conflict with Marathas that have contributed to the downfall of the Mughal Empire. Candidates stated about the war techniques of Marathas due to which Mughals were unable to compete with them. Mughals fought with Marathas for at least 27 years. They specified that Mughals lost their treasure as they invested money in training their army. Better responses also mentioned that as the Mughals were busy in Deccan, it led to the initiation of revolts in other parts of the subcontinent. These reasons actually weakened the power of Mughal Empire in the sub-continent.

Example:

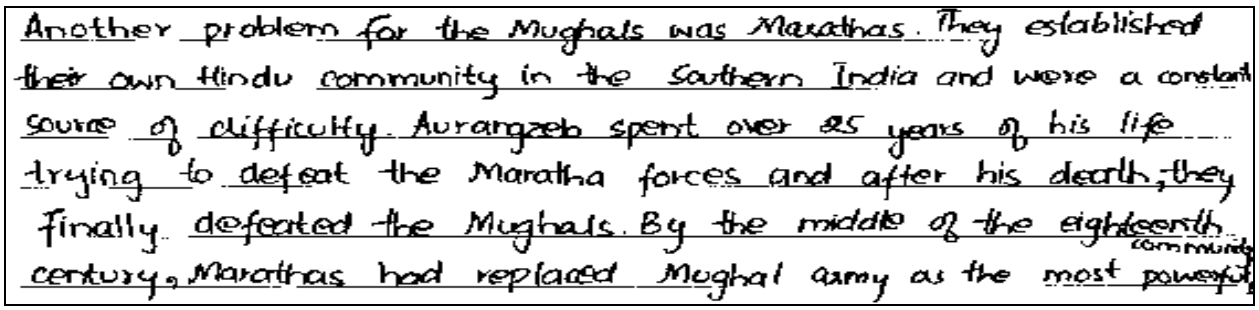

Continuous conflict with Marathas financially weakened the Mughal empire as Marathas wasr technique was Gorilla war technique in which they used to attack from all possible places, to fight with them mughals needed to invest a lot of money as their military expertise had declined and army was not so professional, it needed expenditure but still were unable to defeat Marathas.

Weaker responses generally mentioned the fight between Mughals and Nadir Shah's army. They have mentioned that Nadir Shah took all the money and jewellery of Mughals which weakened the whole Empire. Some of the weaker responses stated that Marathas established their own Hindu community in the Southern India which was a source of difficulty for the Mughals. After the death of Aurangzeb, Marathas replaced Mughals in the subcontinent which was not true. Some of the responses mentioned all the reasons which led to the weakness of the Empire rather than specifying the reason of Marathas which was the demand of the question.

Example 1:


Nadir Shah defeded M. Shah's forceses. He wanted get get as much booty as possible. He took all the gold and jewellery of Mughals and he also took the prestiges of mughals. He don't wanted to be empire. He just wanted the money

Example 2:


Another problem for the Mughals was Marathas. They established their own Hindu community in the Southern India and were a constant source of difficulty. Aurangzeb spent over 25 years of his life trying to defeat the Maratha forces and after his death, they finally defeated the Mughals. By the middle of the eighteenth century, Marathas had replaced Mughal army as the most powerful community

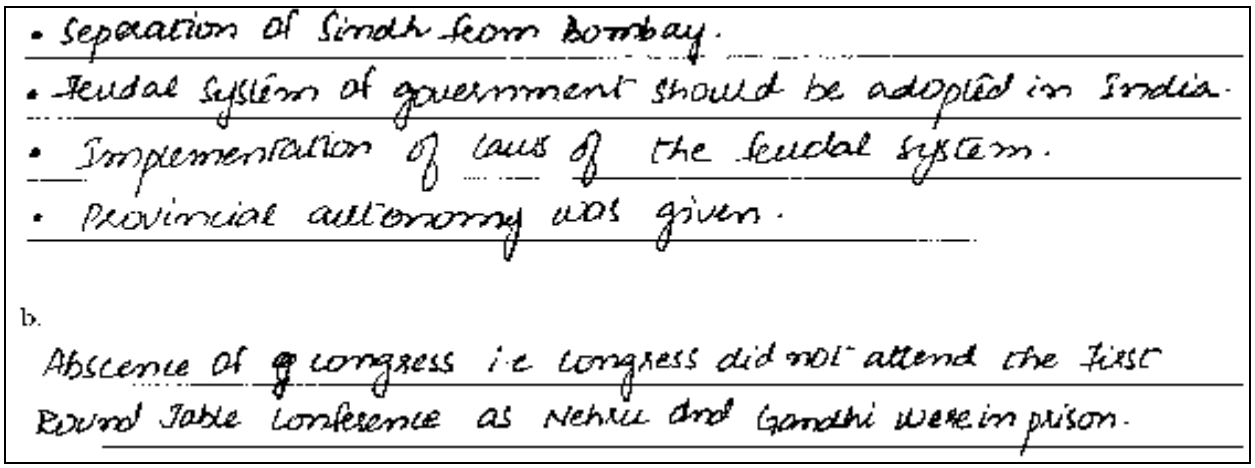
Question 4:

a. What were the agreements reached during the First Round Table Conference held in London in 1930?

b. What greatly contributed to the failure of the First Round Table Conference?

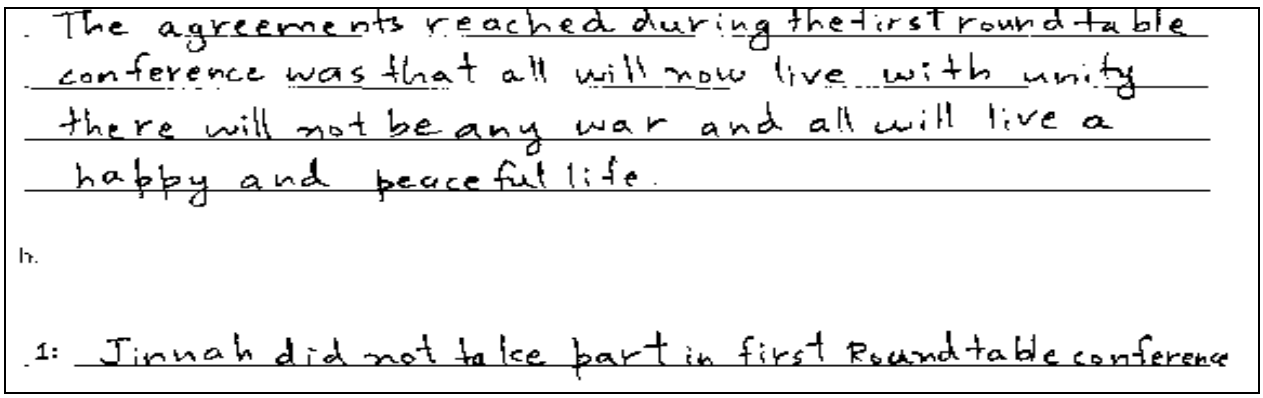
Better responses were those which highlighted the agreements of First Round Table Conference held in London in 1930 such as separation of Sindh from Bombay, adoption of federal system of government in the subcontinent etc. They were able to state that due to the absence of Congress ministries in the conference, it did not succeed.

Example:

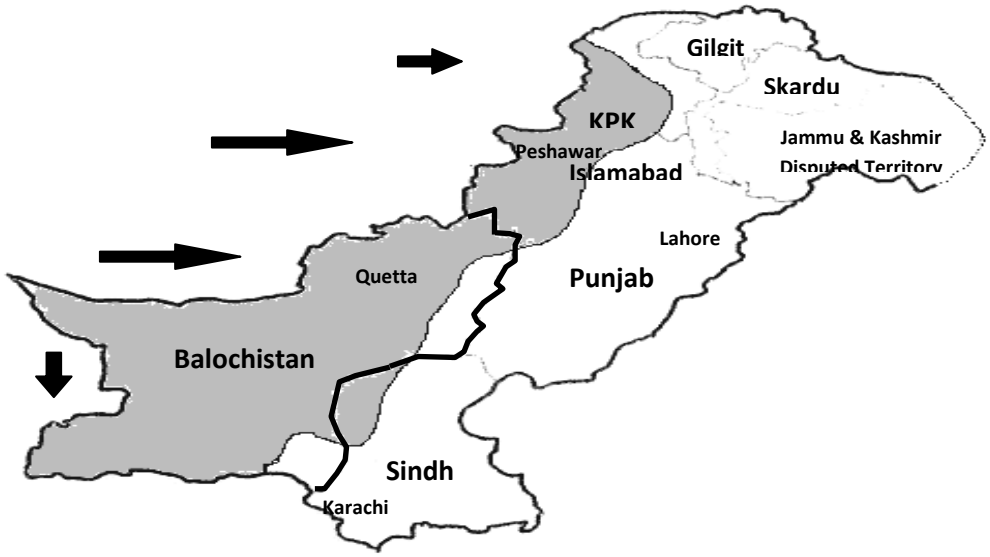


Weaker responses could not comprehend the question and mentioned general points that now onwards both Hindus and Muslims will live together in the subcontinent in unity and will lead a happy and peaceful life. Muhammad Ali Jinnah was blamed for not attending the conference which was totally incorrect. Some responses mentioned that there was no success of this conference.

Example:



Question 5:



a. Precipitation in Pakistan is due to two main factors. Identify the cause of precipitation in the shaded area of the given map.

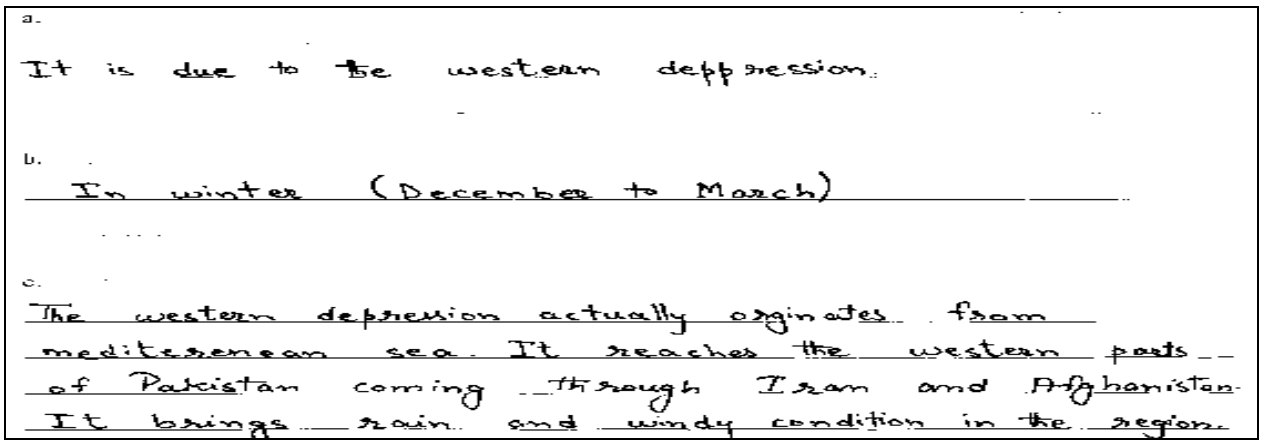
b. In which months, does precipitation take place?

c. How is precipitation formed?

This question was from the past paper, yet the performance of the candidates was not up to the expectation.

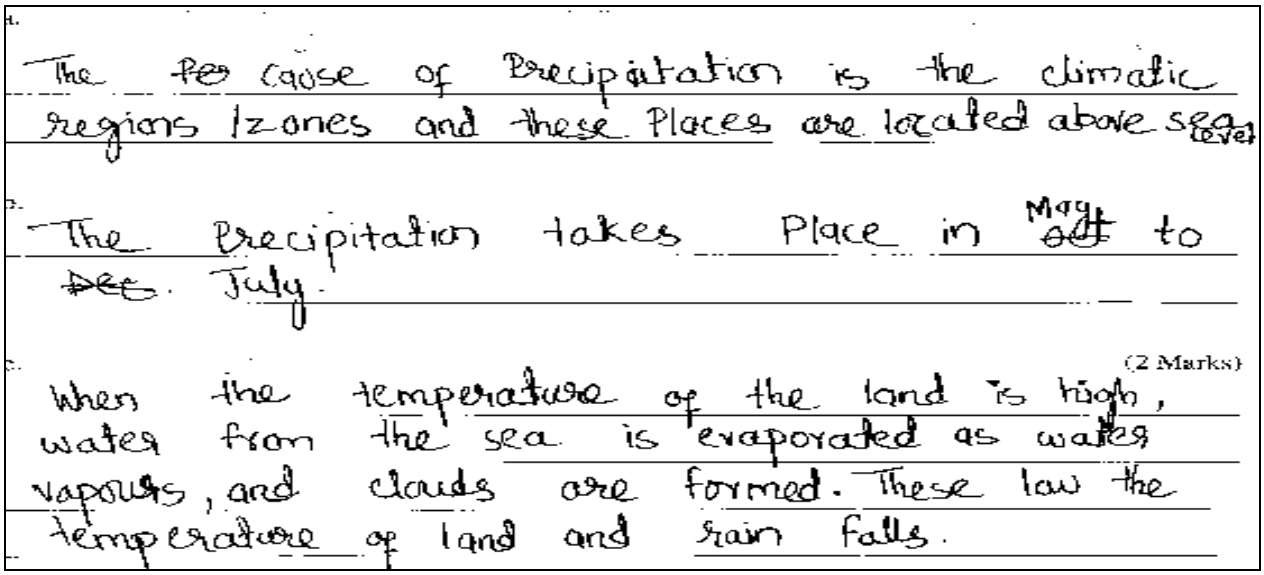
Better responses identified the correct cause of precipitation in the shaded area of the given map, correct names of months between September to March for the precipitation to take place. They were able to give appropriate answer about formation of precipitation such as that western depression actually originates from the Mediterranean Sea in the form of cyclones reaching towards the western parts of Pakistan coming through Iran and Afghanistan. It then brings rain to the region.

Example:


a.
It is due to the western depression.
b.
In winter (December to March)
c.
The western depression actually orginates from mediterreneam sea. It reaches the western parts of Pakistan coming through Iran and Afghanistan. It brings rain and windy condition in the region.

Weaker responses were unable to identify the correct cause of precipitation in the shaded area of the map. They were also not able to write the correct names of the months where the precipitation takes place and thus, they were unable to explain the formation of precipitation correctly.

Example:

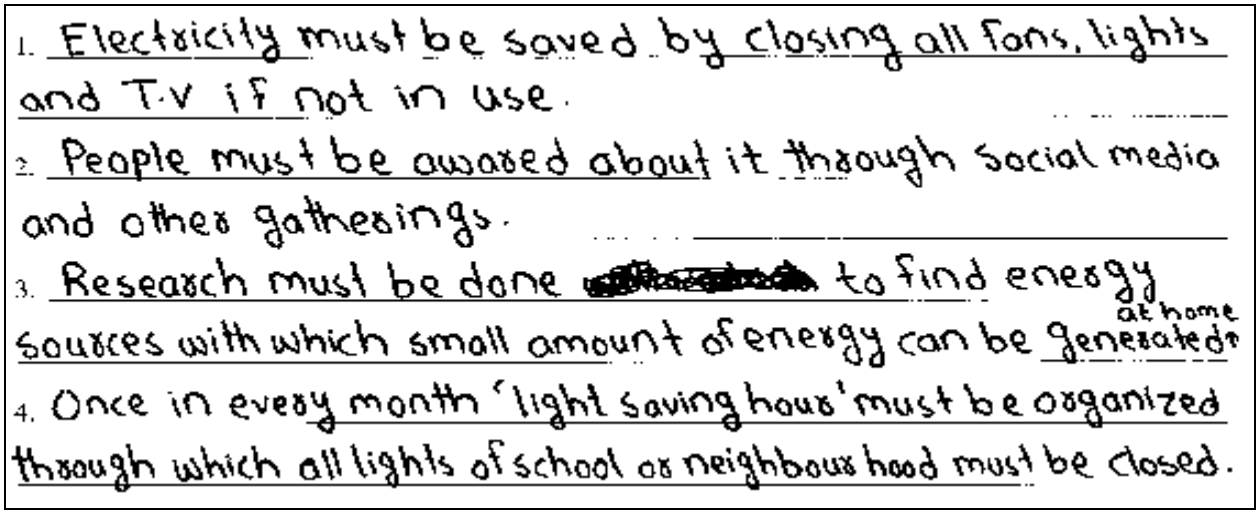

a.
The the cause of Precipitation is the climatic regions /zones and these Places are located above sea level
b.
The Precipitation takes Place in May to July.
c. (2 Marks)
When the temperature of the land is high, water from the sea is evaporated as water vapours, and clouds are formed. These low the temperature of land and rain falls.

Question 6:

What steps can be taken by a student to overcome the energy crisis in Pakistan.

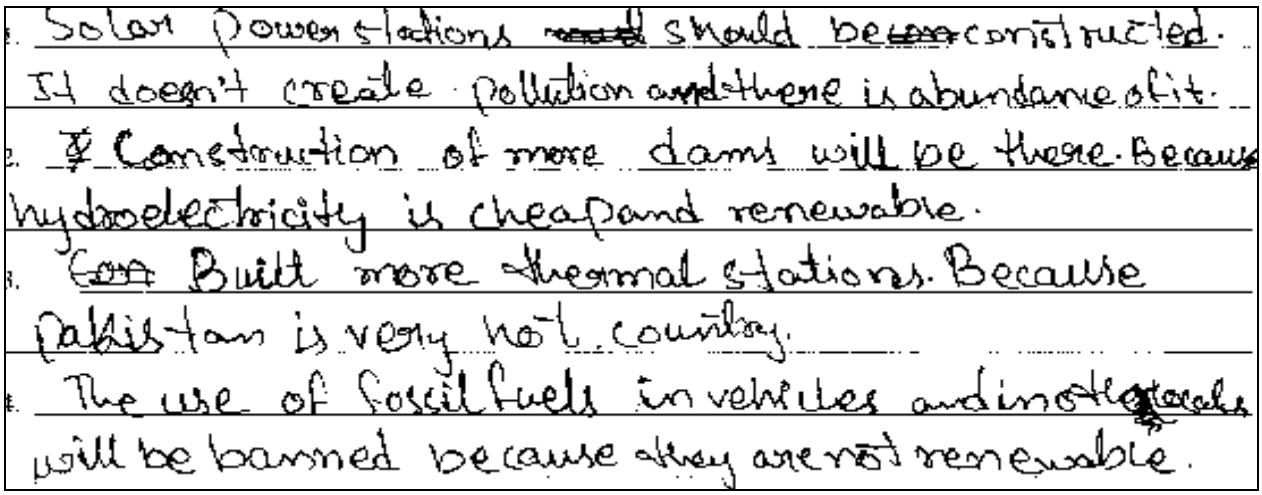
Better responses clearly mentioned the steps taken to overcome the energy crisis in Pakistan. A student should switch off unnecessary lights and fans when they are not in use. They should aware people about saving electricity through banners, posters, arranging social gatherings or using media effectively. They should find an alternative source to generate energy at home so that it can be saved.

Example:



Weaker Responses merely described general steps to be taken as a whole but not as a student. They were unable to comprehend the questions well and mentioned general steps such as setting up of solar power stations, dams, thermal stations etc. should be constructed by the government. Such responses reflected that the candidates did not read the question carefully and overlooked the question specified the steps that a student can take.

Example:


1. Solar Power stations ~~would~~ should be ~~con~~ constructed. It doesn't create pollution and there is abundance of it.
2. ~~I~~ Construction of more dams will be there. Because hydroelectricity is cheap and renewable.
3. ~~Gov~~ Built more thermal stations. Because Pakistan is very hot country.
4. The use of fossil fuels in vehicles and industries will be banned because they are not renewable.

Question 7:

Complete the given table with reference to the forests found in Pakistan.

Type of Forest	Areas Where Found	Importance
Mangrove Forests		Provide breeding grounds for fishes
Alpine Forests		
Riverain or Bella Forests	Along the bank of river Indus and its tributaries	

Better responses clearly provided the information about Mangrove, Alpine and Riverine forests that are found in Pakistan. For example Mangrove forests are found near Makran coast, Alpine forests are found near Chitral, Dir which provide fire wood. Similarly, Riverine forests provide wood of Sishum and Babul to make furniture and are also used for agriculture purpose.

Example:

Types of Forest	Areas Where Found	Importance
Mangrove Forests	Makran Coast Karachi (Sindh) coast.	Provide breeding grounds for fishes
Alpine Forests	Chitral Mureeree Kohistan	- It provides firewood. - It helps in transpiration - Attract tourism industry
Riverain or Bella Forests	Along the bank of river Indus and its tributaries	It provides shade near the rivers and ~~how~~ produces shisham and Babul which is used in manufacturing furniture.

Weaker responses were not able to provide the specific answers about the location of the forests of Mangrove, Alpine and Riverine. The answers did not have the correct importance of these forests. Candidates wrote the importance of forests in general, such as they help in keeping the environment fresh, regulate rainfall etc., which was not the requirement of the question.

Example:

Type of Forest	Areas Where Found	Importance
Mangrove Forests	Tropical area	Provide breeding grounds for fishes
Alpine Forests	Mountaneous regions.	Tourism sites, Provides Medicines.
Riverain or Bella Forests	Along the bank of river Indus and its tributaries	Maintains the Temperature

Extended Response Questions (ERQs)

This question offered a choice between part **a** and **b**. Part **a** was based on history whereas part **b** was from the topic of resources of Pakistan. Majority of the candidates attempted option **b** and did well**.**

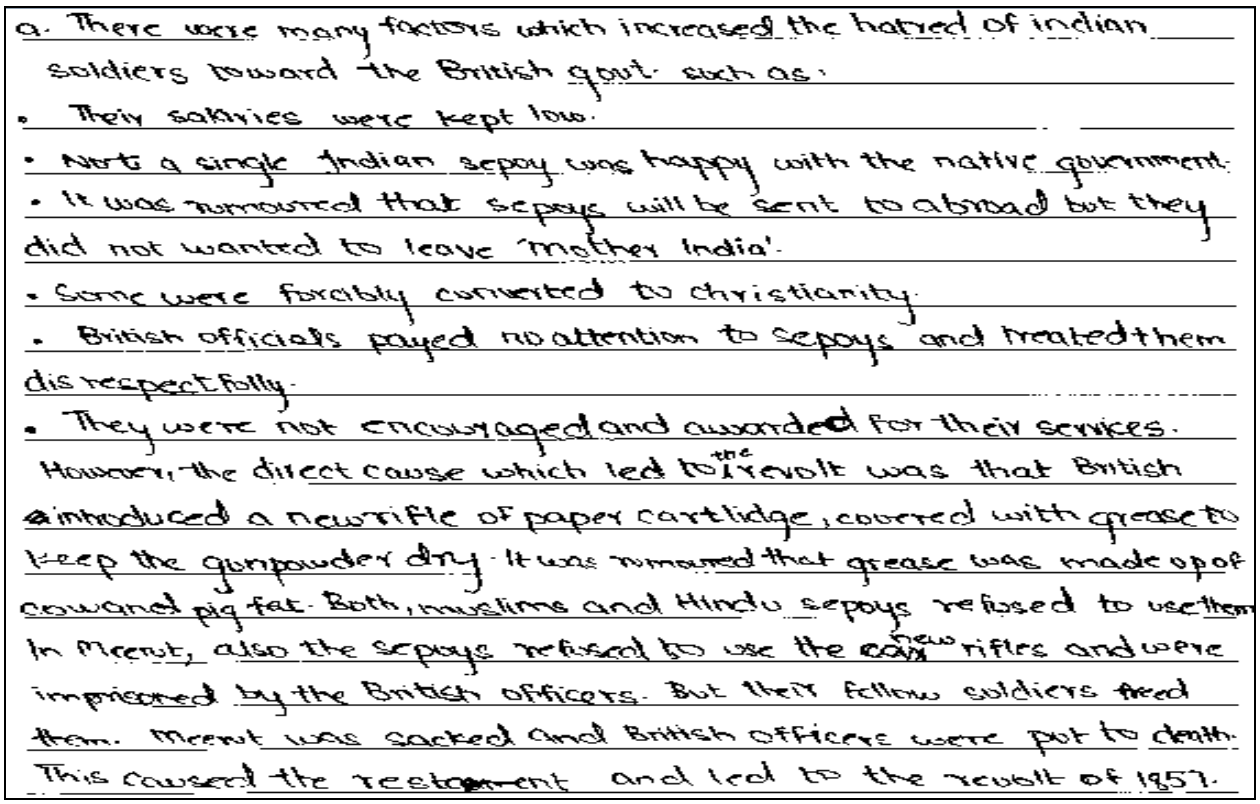
Question 8a:

The Indian Revolt of 1857 did not have a single cause. Instead, several factors contributed to its origin.

Explain the factors which increased the hatred of Indian soldiers toward the British government and eventually led to the revolt.

Better responses mentioned relevant factors that increased the hatred of Indian soldiers in particular toward the British government. Such as, the Indian soldiers employed in the British army gradually became restless because of the discriminating attitude of the British officers. Candidates wrote that the Indian soldiers were paid very low salary. In many occasions they requested for the increase of their pay but their appeal was never granted. There were no promotions for them. They also stated that there was a rumour spread among the soldiers that they might be compelled to embrace Christianity. This type of administrative orders in the regiments created a sense of frustration among the soldiers, which made them bold enough to think of a revolution. Better responses wrote that the introduction of the Enfield rifle with the Greased cartridges created a sensation among the soldiers. It was said that the cartridge contained some animal fat (fat of cows or pigs) on it. It made the soldiers furious and initiated a military revolt.

Example:



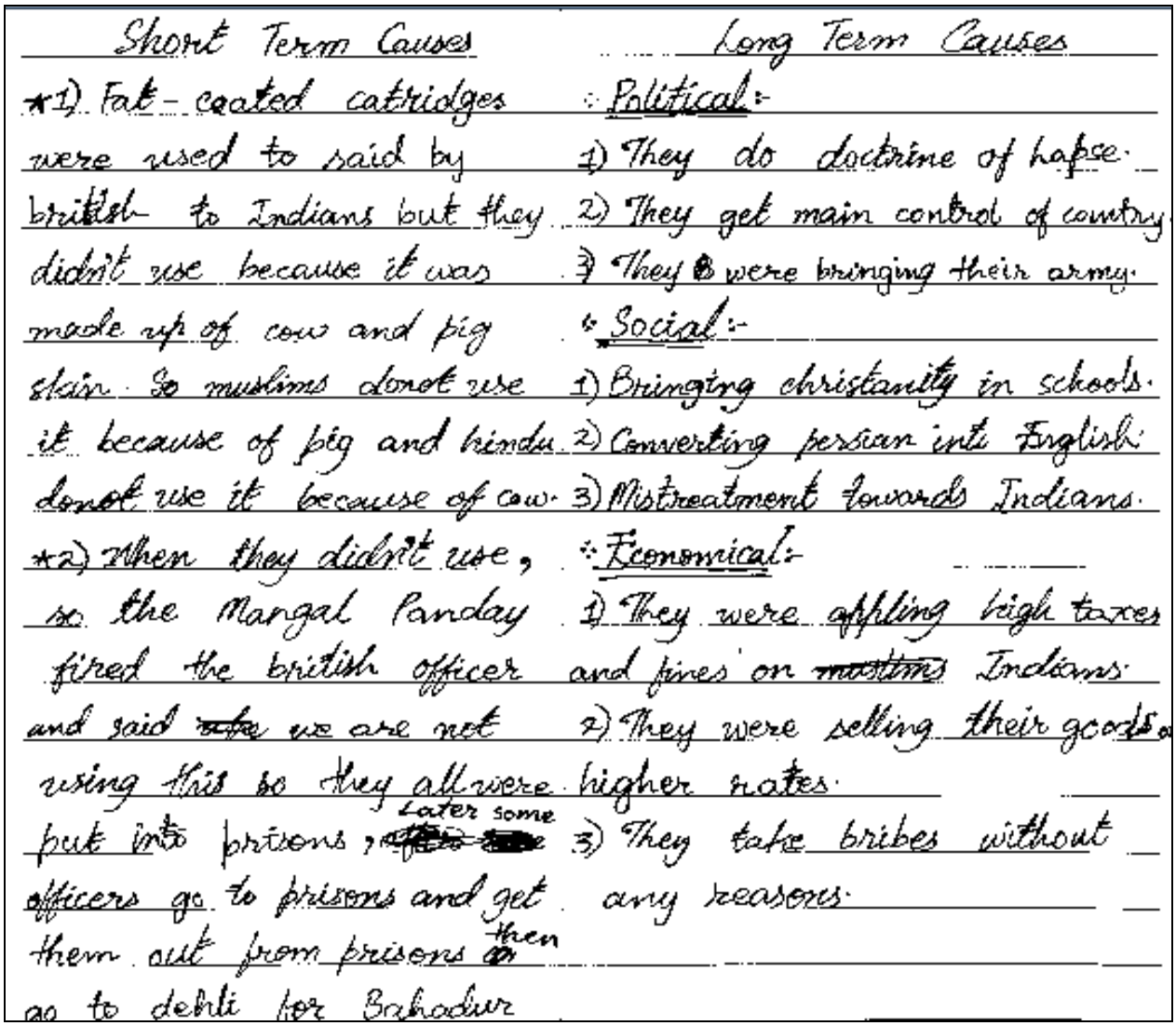
a. There were many factors which increased the hatred of indian soldiers toward the British govt. such as:

- Their salaries were kept low.
- Not a single indian sepoy was happy with the native government.
- It was rumoured that sepoys will be sent to abroad but they did not wanted to leave 'mother India'.
- Some were forcably converted to christianity.
- British officials payed no attention to sepoys and treated them disrespectfully.
- They were not encouraged and awarded for their services.

However, the direct cause which led to the revolt was that British introduced a new rifle of paper cartridge, covered with grease to keep the gunpowder dry. It was rumoured that grease was made of of cow and pig fat. Both, muslims and Hindu sepoys refused to use them. In Meerut, also the sepoys refused to use the new rifles and were imprisoned by the British officers. But their fellow soldiers freed them. Meerut was sacked and British officers were put to death. This caused the resentment and led to the revolt of 1857.

Weaker responses were the ones where the candidates were unable to meet the demand of the asked questions. Overall they provided general points except for one or two relevant points. The answers have story of Mangal Panday, information about paying high taxes, bribery taken by the British officials etc. which was not required by the question. The candidates have actually mentioned all the causes of the war of independence 1857 rather than the ones associated with the soldiers only.

Example:



Short Term Causes

*1) Fat-coated catridges were used to said by British to Indians but they didn't use because it was made up of cow and pig stain. So muslims don't use it because of pig and hindu don't use it because of cow.

*2) When they didn't use, so the Mangal Panday fired the british officer and said ~~we~~ we are not using this so they all were put into prisons, ~~Later some officers~~ Later some officers go to prisons and get them out from prisons ~~on~~ then go to delhi for Bahadur

Long Term Causes

∴ Political :-

1) They do doctrine of lapse.
2) They get main control of country.
3) They were bringing their army.

∴ Social :-

1) Bringing christianity in schools.
2) Converting persian into English
3) Mistreatment towards Indians.

∴ Economical :-

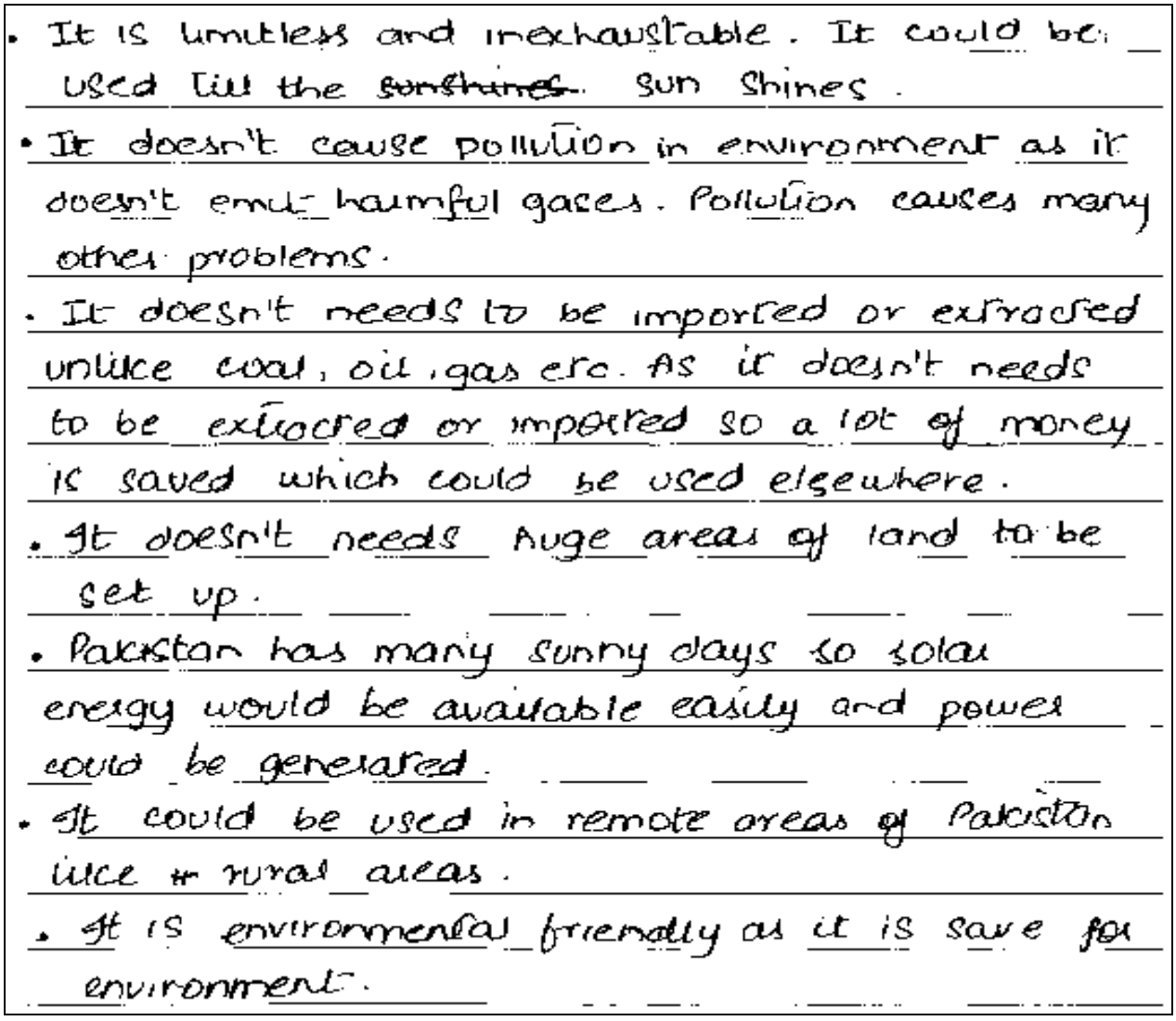
1) They were ~~applying~~ applying high taxes and fines on ~~muslims~~ Indians.
2) They were selling their goods higher rates.
3) They take bribes without any reasons.

Question 8b:

Why is solar energy considered to be the best alternative means of energy in Pakistan?

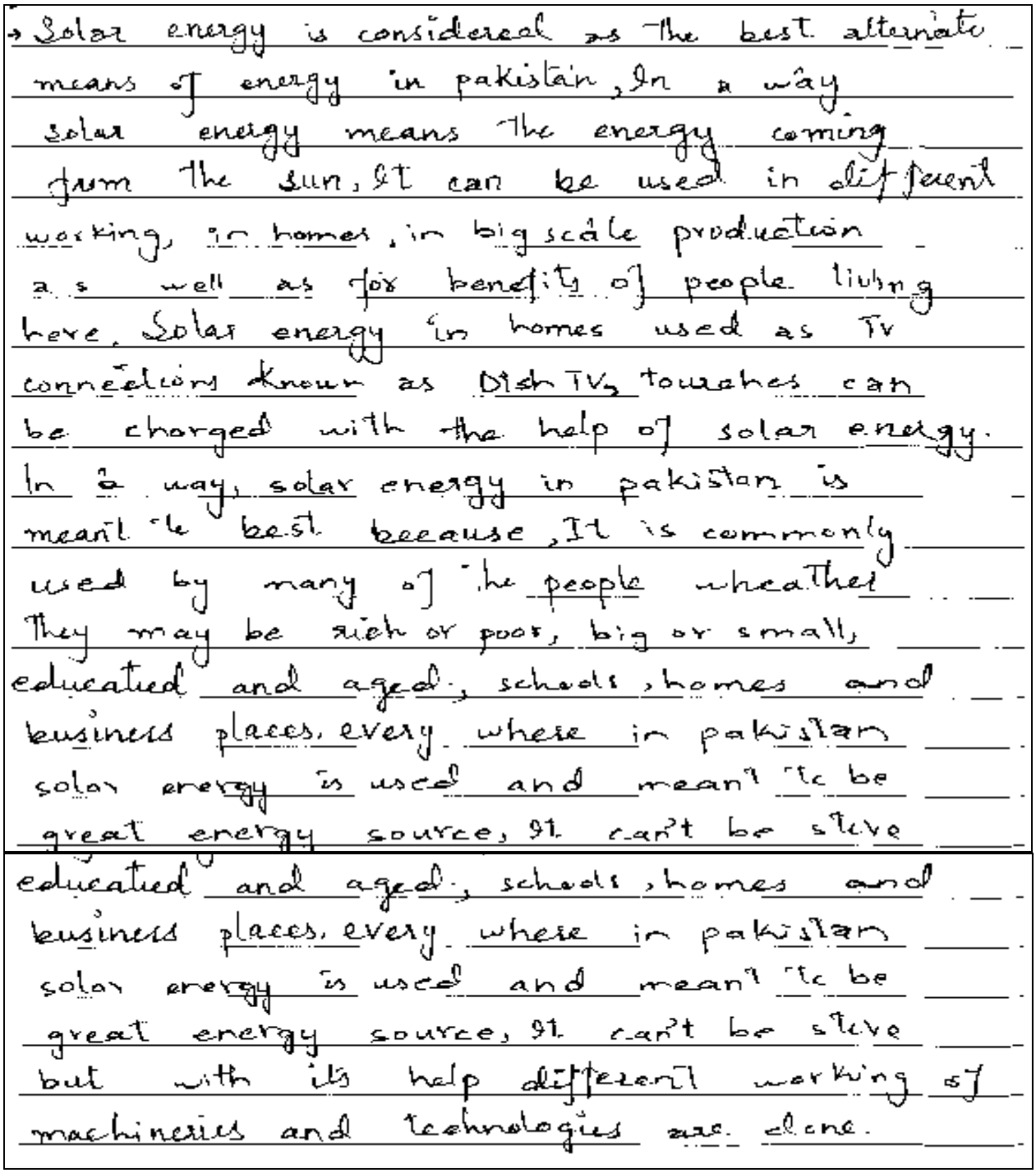
Better responses clearly mentioned the reasons to consider solar energy as the best alternative means of energy in Pakistan such as it is environmental friendly, it does not need coal, oil to be imported, it does not need a huge area to set up things, it is a renewable energy source etc. Candidates wrote that the ability to produce electricity off the grid is a major advantage of solar energy for people who live in isolated and rural areas. Better responses also stated that position of Pakistan geographically allows 6 to 8 hours of sunshine on average. It is cheap and cost effective. Sunlight is free of charge, so once the solar system at a place is developed, electricity costs will be reduced.

Example:



Weaker responses were unable to comprehend the question properly. Candidates wrote irrelevant points like; solar energy can be used in different places such as homes, schools, business place, restaurants etc. Some of them mentioned that it can be used as TV connections. Some of the candidates also mentioned the entire process of the generation of solar energy rather than why it is best alternate for Pakistan.

Example:



→ Solar energy is considered as the best alternate means of energy in pakistan, In a way solar energy means the energy coming from the sun, It can be used in different working, in homes, in big scale production as well as for benefity of people living here. Solar energy in homes used as TV connections known as Dish TVs tooathes can be charged with the help of solar energy. In a way, solar energy in pakistan is meant to be best because, It is commonly used by many of the people wheather they may be rich or poor, big or small, educated and aged, schools, homes and business places, every where in pakistan solar energy is used and meant to be great energy source, It can't be stove

educated and aged, schools, homes and business places, every where in pakistan solar energy is used and meant to be great energy source, It can't be stove

but with its help different working of machineries and technologies are done.